

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

CHAPTER 5: IDEAS THAT HAVE HELPED MANKIND (BY BERTRAND RUSSELL)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"Ideas That Have Helped Mankind" is an intellectual essay by Bertrand Russell. He discusses how crucial ideas like the invention of fire, speech, agriculture, and domestication of animals helped humans evolve from wild creatures into a civilized society. Russell stresses balancing technical skills with moral progress to avoid self-destruction.

 15 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. How did the increase in human numbers help mankind, according to Russell?

Ans: The increase in numbers helped mankind because a larger population meant more collective strength, better chances of survival, and the development of a complex civilization.

Q2. Were humans happier than birds and animals in prehistoric times?

Ans: No, humans were not necessarily happier. Like animals, humans suffered from cold and starvation, but humans additionally suffered from the mental anxiety of anticipating future disasters.

Q3. What are the two broad categories of ideas that have helped mankind?

Ans: The two broad categories are: (a) Ideas contributing to knowledge and technique (skills), and (b) Ideas concerned with morals and politics.

Q4. How did the invention of language or speech help mankind?

Ans: Language helped mankind by enabling the transmission of knowledge, ideas, and experiences from one generation to the next, which is the foundation of culture.

Q5. Why does Russell say that the invention of fire was a great turning point?

Ans: Fire helped humans cook food, keep themselves warm during freezing winters, and protect themselves from wild and dangerous animals.

Q6. How did agriculture change the lifestyle of early humans?

Ans: Agriculture forced early humans to abandon their nomadic wandering life and settle down in one place, leading to the birth of villages and stable societies.



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Q7. What was the dark side of early agriculture mentioned by Russell?

Ans: The dark side was that early agriculture was often connected with bloodlust, human sacrifice, and superstitious rituals to please the gods for a good harvest.

Q8. How did the domestication of animals benefit human civilization?

Ans: Taming animals like cows, horses, and sheep provided humans with food, milk, clothing, and heavy labor for transport and farming.

Q9. In what way are humans superior to animals intellectually?

Ans: Humans possess abstract thinking, scientific curiosity, artistic expression, and cumulative knowledge, whereas animals live purely by instinct.

Q10. What does the author mean by "taming of impulses"?

Ans: It means that civilization requires humans to control their wild, aggressive animal instincts and act according to laws, reason, and social cooperation.

Q11. Why is our technical knowledge a danger without moral progress?

Ans: Without moral values, advanced technical skills (like making nuclear bombs) are used to destroy other human beings in wars, threatening human extinction.

Q12. How do birds die in winter, and how is it different from human suffering?

Ans: Birds die of starvation during winter without knowing why it happened. Humans, however, suffer mentally by worrying about winter long before it arrives.

Q13. What role did mathematics and astronomy play in early human history?

Ans: They helped early humans understand seasons, keep track of time, navigate oceans, and manage agricultural cycles efficiently.

Q14. What does Russell say about the utilization of leisure?

Ans: Russell notes that as machines and techniques saved time, humans gained leisure, which allowed them to develop art, music, literature, and philosophy.

Q15. What is the ultimate message of this essay?

Ans: The ultimate message is that human survival depends on choosing universal brotherhood, intelligence, and moral values over tribal hatred and destructive weapons.

🎯 50 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'Ideas That Have Helped Mankind' is written by: (A) Shiga Naoya (B) Bertrand Russell (C) H.E. Bates (D) Anton Chekhov

2. Bertrand Russell was a British philosopher, historian, and: (A) Mathematician (B) Scientist (C) Doctor (D) Politician



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3. Bertrand Russell was awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature in the year: (A) 1945 (B) 1950 (C) 1962 (D) 1970
4. Bertrand Russell belonged to which country?: (A) America (B) Britain (C) Germany (D) France
5. This lesson 'Ideas That Have Helped Mankind' is a/an: (A) Short story (B) Drama (C) Essay (D) Novel extract
6. The most obvious way in which ideas have helped mankind is through the increase of: (A) weapons (B) population / numbers (C) diseases (D) hatred
7. In ancient prehistoric times, humans lived like: (A) kings (B) wild beasts / animals (C) scientists (D) gods
8. Unlike animals, human beings suffer from mental: (A) happiness (B) anxiety and anticipation (C) peace (D) safety
9. During winter, large numbers of birds die of: (A) overeating (B) heat (C) starvation and cold (D) hunting
10. Animals live purely by their: (A) education (B) books (C) instincts (D) laws
11. Which of the following is not an animal instinct?: (A) Eating (B) Sleeping (C) Scientific thinking (D) Running away from fire
12. The two main categories of helpful ideas are knowledge/technique and: (A) weapons (B) morals and politics (C) business (D) sports
13. The most difficult and important early step in human evolution was the invention of: (A) internet (B) language / speech (C) trains (D) guns
14. The use of fire was a great step because it was used for: (A) cooking food (B) making weapons (C) destroying forests (D) fun
15. Early humans initially kept fire alive to scare away wild: (A) birds (B) beasts / animals (C) children (D) ghosts
16. The idea of settling down in villages came after the invention of: (A) clothes (B) printing press (C) agriculture (D) writing
17. Before agriculture, humans led a continuous _____ life.: (A) settled (B) nomadic / wandering (C) peaceful (D) luxury
18. Early agricultural practices were unfortunately associated with human: (A) sacrifice / blood (B) education (C) peace (D) sports
19. Which animal was first domesticated by early humans according to history?: (A) Lion (B) Elephant (C) Dog / Cow (D) Tiger
20. Domestication of animals provided humans with food, transport, and: (A) internet (B) companion/labor (C) money (D) weapons
21. The introduction of the alphabet and writing helped to store human: (A) money (B) knowledge and history (C) food (D) weapons



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22. The taming of our wild impulses is a sign of true: (A) ignorance (B) civilization (C) cruelty (D) madness
23. Human beings have unique pleasures that are derived from: (A) instinct only (B) intellect and art (C) sleeping (D) hunting
24. We are less cruel to those inside our herd, but more cruel to those: (A) inside the family (B) outside our herd / tribe (C) who are dead (D) who are rich
25. Russell notes that the progress of mankind has been towards more: (A) wars (B) isolation (C) skill and knowledge (D) poverty
26. Civilization teaches us to be more _____ towards our fellow human beings.: (A) hostile (B) friendly and cooperative (C) jealous (D) angry
27. Without the knowledge of mathematics, the science of _____ could not exist.: (A) cooking (B) astronomy / physics (C) singing (D) dancing
28. The utilization of time saved by machines gave mankind: (A) stress (B) leisure (C) poverty (D) illness
29. Anthropomorphic ideas led early humans to believe that gods required blood for a good: (A) rain (B) harvest / crop (C) hunting (D) match
30. Bertrand Russell was a vocal advocate for peace and opposed: (A) education (B) nuclear weapons and wars (C) science (D) democracy
31. "The mind is a restless bird" appears in Chapter 1, but "Ideas That Have Helped Mankind" shows progress of human: (A) money (B) intellect (C) body (D) wings
32. Early humans suffered terribly from the lack of: (A) cellphones (B) clothes and shelter (C) cars (D) universities
33. Invention of printing occurred in the: (A) prehistoric times (B) later stages of civilization (C) ancient Egypt (D) stone age
34. The concept of democracy is a contribution belonging to: (A) animals (B) morals and politics (C) nature (D) mathematics
35. Man's survival was at one time a very _____ question.: (A) easy (B) doubtful / difficult (C) funny (D) certain
36. Human beings can pass on their learned skills to the next generation via: (A) dreams (B) education and writing (C) instinct (D) blood
37. Robin birds kill old robins, whereas human civilization tries to protect its: (A) weapons (B) old and sick people (C) animals (D) enemies
38. According to Russell, the worst human quality is our capacity for: (A) love (B) organized warfare and hatred (C) learning (D) art
39. The safety of the human herd depends upon internal: (A) conflict (B) laws and cooperation (C) weapons (D) isolation
40. In human history, the era of machines began after the discovery of: (A) fire (B) steam and

